# Before organizational behaviour

Frederick Taylor (1856-1915) ‘the father of scientific management’

Focus:

- To select the best people for the job;
- To instruct them in the best methods;
- To give financial incentives in the form of piece work

One problem: ‘group norms’

# Hawthorne effect

1920's – series of experiments at the Hawthorne Plant of Western Electric, Chicago

Found that simply showing an interest in a group increased productivity

Theory X: there is a need for coercion, direction, and control of people at work

Theory Y: work is as natural as rest or play

# Selecting the best people

Belbin distinguishes between **eligible** (having the right qualifications) and **suitable** candidates (can do the job).

The danger is employ someone who is eligible but not suitable

The best situation is to employ someone who is suitable but not eligible! For example, these are likely to be cheaper and to stay in the job.

# Do good software developers have innate characteristics?

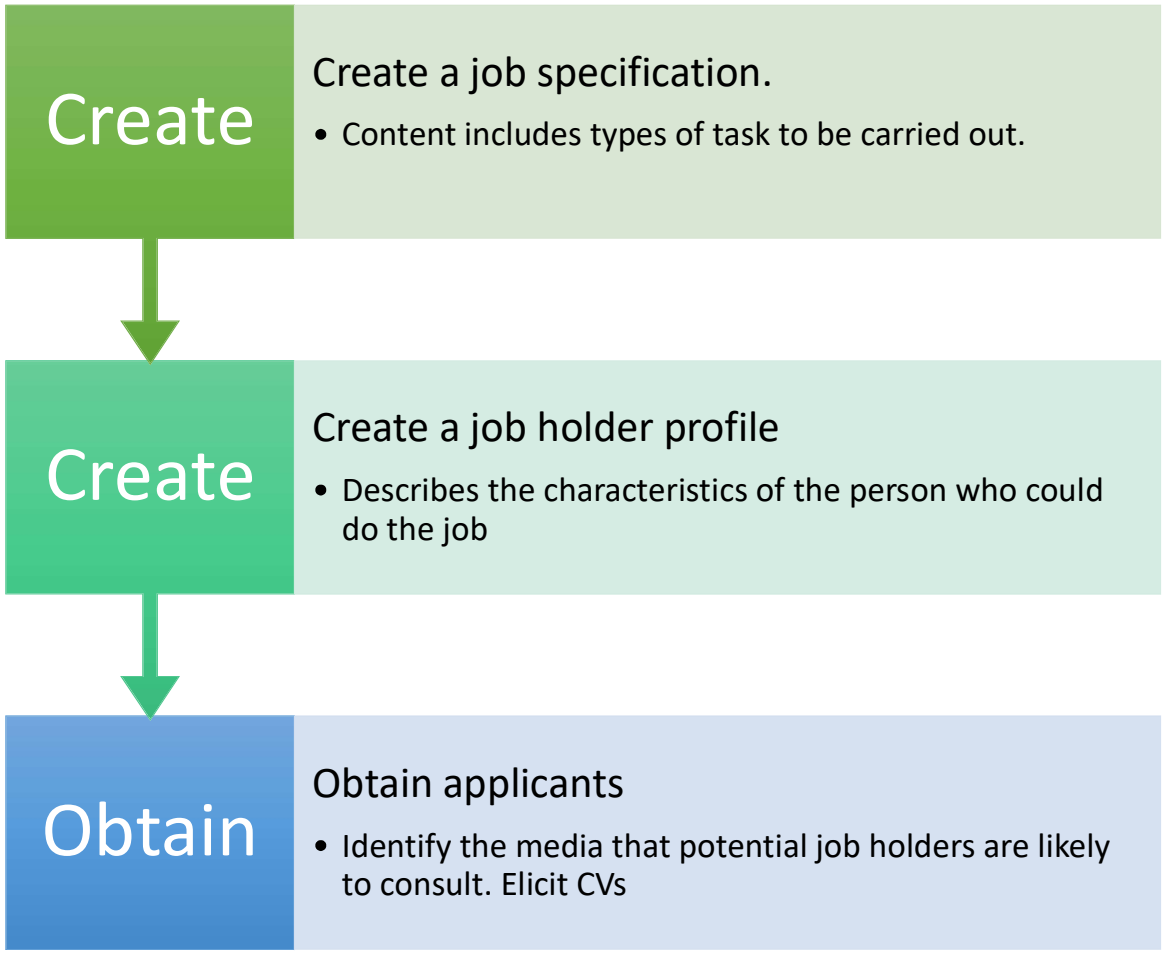
1968 study – difference of 1:25 in time taken by different programmers to code program

Other research found experience better than maths skills as a guide to software skills

Some research suggested software developers less sociable than other workers

Later surveys have found no significant social differences between IT workers and others – this could be result of broader role of IT in organizations

# A selection process



# A selection process - continued

4. **Select potential candidates from CVs.**

   Do not waste everybody's time interviewing people whose CV clearly indicates are unsuitable.

5. **Further selection, including interview**

   Selection processes could include aptitude tests, examination of work portfolios. Make sure selection processes map to the job holder profile

6. **Other procedures**.

   e.g. taking up references, medicals etc

# Instruction in the best methods

- The induction of new staff should be carefully planned – worst case where new recruit is simply ignored and not given any tasks
- Good induction leads to new recruit becoming productive more quickly
- Need to review staff progress frequently and provide feedback
- Need to identify training that could enhance staff effectiveness.

# Motivation

Motivation and application can often make up for shortfalls in innate skills

Taylor's approach - financial incentives

Abraham Maslow (1908-1970)

- motivations vary from individual to individual
- hierarchy of needs – as lower ones fulfilled, higher ones emerge
- Lowest level – food, shelter
- Highest level – self-actualization

As a lower level of needs is satisfied then gradually a higher level of need emerges.

# Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

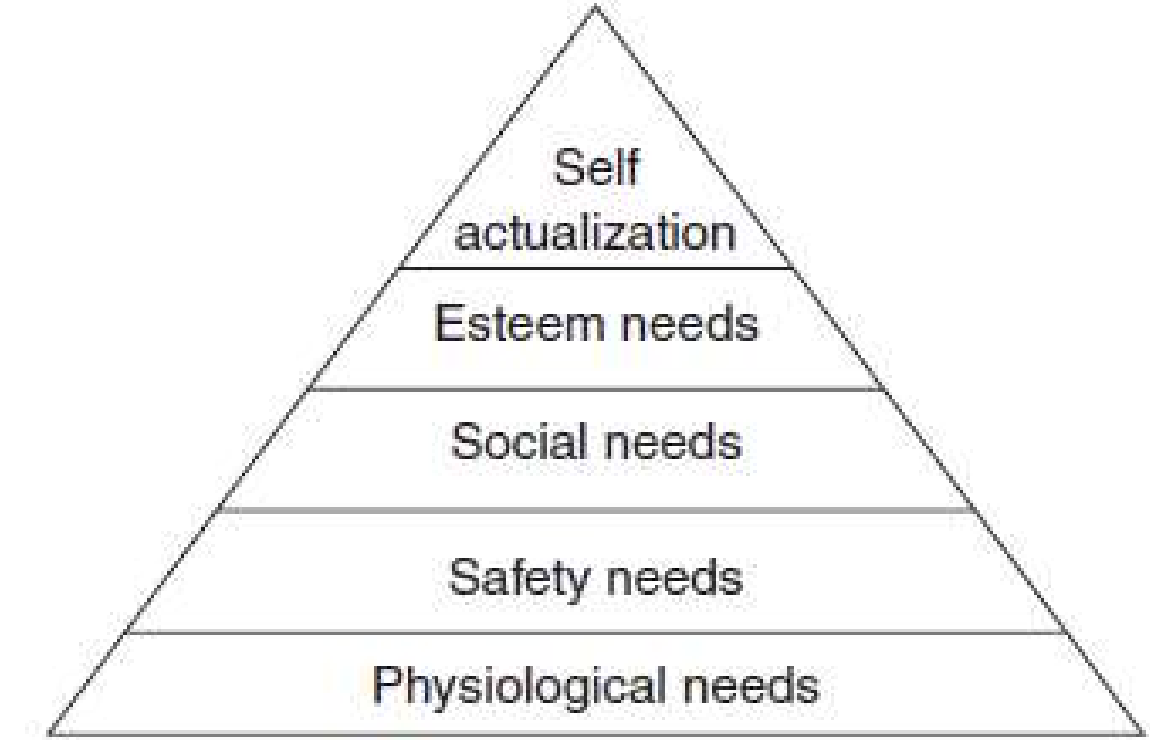



FIGURE 11.2 Maslow's hierarchy of needs.

# Take Home Task

Q1e. Define Net Profit, Payback Period and Returns on Investment. Calculate these values for the following cash flow forecast of a project.

# Herzberg

Herzberg suggested two sets of factors affected job satisfaction

1. *Hygiene* or *maintenance factors* – make you dissatisfied if they are not right e.g. pay, working conditions
2. *Motivators* – make you feel the job is worthwhile e.g. a sense of achievement

# Vroom

Vroom and colleagues identified these influences on motivation

*Expectancy* – the belief that working harder leads to better performance

*Instrumentality* – the belief that better performance will be rewarded

Perceived value – of the resulting reward

# Oldham-Hackman job characteristics

Identified the following characteristics of a job which make it more ‘meaningful’

- Skill variety
- Task identity
- Task significance

Two other factors contributed to satisfaction:

- Autonomy - the freedom that you have about the way that you do the job
- Feedback

# Methods to improve job satisfaction

| | |
|---|---|
| Set | Set specific goals |
| Provide | Provide feedback on the progress towards meeting those goals |
| Consider | Consider job redesign<br>• Job enlargement - widening the range of tasks carried out by a worker<br>• Job enrichment – delegating some management roles to the worker |

# Stress

Edward Yourdon quotes a project manager: '*Once a project gets rolling, you should be expecting members to be putting in at least 60 hours a week….The project manager must expect to put in as many hours as possible.'*

1960 study in US: people under 45 who worked more than 48 hours a week twice the risk of death from coronary heart disease.

XP practice – maximum 40 hour working week

# Stress can be reduced by good project management

- Good project management should lead to:
- Reasonable estimates of effort
- Good project control leading fewer unexpected crises
- Making clear what is expected of each team member – reduces **role ambiguity**
- Reduced **role conflict** where a person is torn between conflicting responsibilities
- Bullying tactics are a symptom of incompetent project management.

# Stress Management

## Imagery, relaxation, and meditation

- An example of a simple relaxation technique can be rolling the head from side to side

## Cognitive behaviorial approaches

- Include self-monitoring of stress intensity, thought record-keeping and rewriting, time management, assertiveness training and increased social interactions.

## Systemic approach

- Altering the factors which contribute to stress

# Health and safety

Apart from stress, health and safety less likely to be an issue compared to other engineering projects.

…but sometimes IT infrastructure may be set up as other building work is going on

UK law lays down that organizations employing over 5 staff should have a **written safety policy**

Management of safety should be embedded in project management.

# Health and safety - continued

- Top management must be committed to health and safety (H&S) policy
- Delegation of responsibilities relating to H&S should be clear
- Job descriptions should include H&S related responsibilities
- Need to ensure those given H&S responsibilities should understand and accept them

# Health and safety - continued

- There should be a designated safety officer
- Staff, particularly knowledgeable technical specialists, should consulted about safety
- There should be an adequate H&S budget

# Ethical and professional concerns:

Ethics relates to the moral obligation to respect the rights and interests of others – goes beyond strictly legal responsibilities

Three groups of responsibilities:

Responsibilities that everyone has

Responsibilities that people in organizations have

Responsibilities relating to your profession or calling

# Organizational ethics

There are some who argue that ethical organizational ethics are limited:

**Stockholder theory** (e.g. Milton Friedman). An employee's duty is to the owners of the business (which often means the stakeholders) above all others – although legal requirements must be met.

**Competitive relationships between businesses**. Competition may cause you to do things that could have a negative impact on the owners or employees of competitive businesses

# Professional ethics

- Professionals have knowledge about the technical domain that the general public does not
- Ethical duty of the expert to warn lay people of the risks involved in a particular course of action
- Many professions, or would be professions, have codes of conduct for their members e.g.

<http://www.bcs.org/upload/pdf/cop.pdf>

<http://www.ieee.org/web/aboutus/ethics>

<http://www.apm.org/about/se_code>

# Thank you...

